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Dear Members of the Hiring Committee,

I am a PhD candidate in Economics at the University of Cambridge, expected to complete my dissertation by May 2027. Prior to my PhD, I completed the B.Sc. in Mathematics and Economics at the LSE. I am writing to express my interest in [insert title of position].

My primary research interests are in macro-finance, monetary policy, and international economics. My job market paper, *Decomposing the Investment Channel of Monetary Policy*, studies the response of corporate investment to changes in borrowing costs and how this response differs from the one estimated using conventional monetary-policy shocks, which conflate borrowing-cost effects with belief revisions about future economic fundamentals. To isolate the borrowing-cost channel, we exploit quasi-experimental cross-sectional variation in firms' borrowing costs arising from heterogeneous exposure of otherwise similar firms to the ECB's corporate sector purchase program. We find that investment elasticities estimated from aggregate monetary-policy shocks understate the response to a pure borrowing-cost shock by 38 percent over four quarters. I was awarded the ECB Young Economist Prize 2026 as well as the Cambridge Finance Best Student Paper Award 2026 for this project.

Beyond my job market paper, I have completed two additional research projects that combine quasi-experimental variation with quantitative models to map microeconomic elasticities into aggregate dynamics. In one paper, I exploit a series of US court rulings on sovereign debt litigation to show that direct default costs – not just market exclusion – are an important deterrent to sovereign default. In the second paper, we use proprietary security-holdings data to show that common ownership amplifies volatility from security-idiosyncratic shocks which can substantially contribute to aggregate volatility and financial cycles.

Alongside my research, I have taught undergraduate and graduate courses in econometrics and macroeconomics at the University of Cambridge. I achieved a student satisfaction rating of 86% with students highlighting that classes were well organized and ran smoothly. I can contribute immediately to core undergraduate economics courses and macroeconomics courses across all levels. I would also welcome the chance to teach field courses that connect directly to my research, such as monetary transmission, firm dynamics, sovereign lending, and fixed income securities.

Please find my [CV](#), [Job market paper](#), and other application materials enclosed. More details about my research are available on my [website](#). Letters of recommendation from Elisa Faraglia, Constantine Yannelis, and Vasco Carvalho will be delivered separately. I would be delighted to discuss my application further.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
Lennart Niermann